Bear's Bedtime Steps

A bedtime story for ages 2–6 · about 3 minutes to read aloud

Little Bear did not like bedtime.

"I'm not tired," said Little Bear, bouncing on the bed. "Not even a tiny bit."

Mama Bear smiled. "Then let's do the bedtime steps. Just to practise."

Step one: a warm bath. Little Bear splashed and made bubble hats, and the warm water made his paws feel soft and slow.

Step two: cosy pyjamas. They were blue, with stars on them, and they smelled like clean laundry.

Step three: brush, brush, brush. Top teeth, bottom teeth, all the way to the back. Little Bear yawned in the middle of brushing, but he said that didn't count.

Step four: lights down. Mama Bear turned off the big light and turned on the little lamp shaped like the moon.

Step five: one story. Just one. It was about a fox who couldn't find his favourite hat. Little Bear's eyes were getting heavy, but he wanted to know where the hat was. (It was on the fox's head the whole time.)

Step six: three big breaths. In through the nose, like smelling honey. Out through the mouth, like blowing out a candle. In... and out. In... and out. In... and out.

Step seven: a snuggle and a whisper. "Goodnight, Little Bear. I love you."

"I'm still not tired," whispered Little Bear, with his eyes already closed.

And by the time Mama Bear got to the door, he was fast asleep.

The end.

For grown-ups: A short, same-every-night routine helps many children settle. If the grown-ups' bedtime could use a routine too, Sleepward is a free iPhone bedtime routine app. · Free story from Honest Little Apps · honestlittleapps.github.io/bedtime-stories